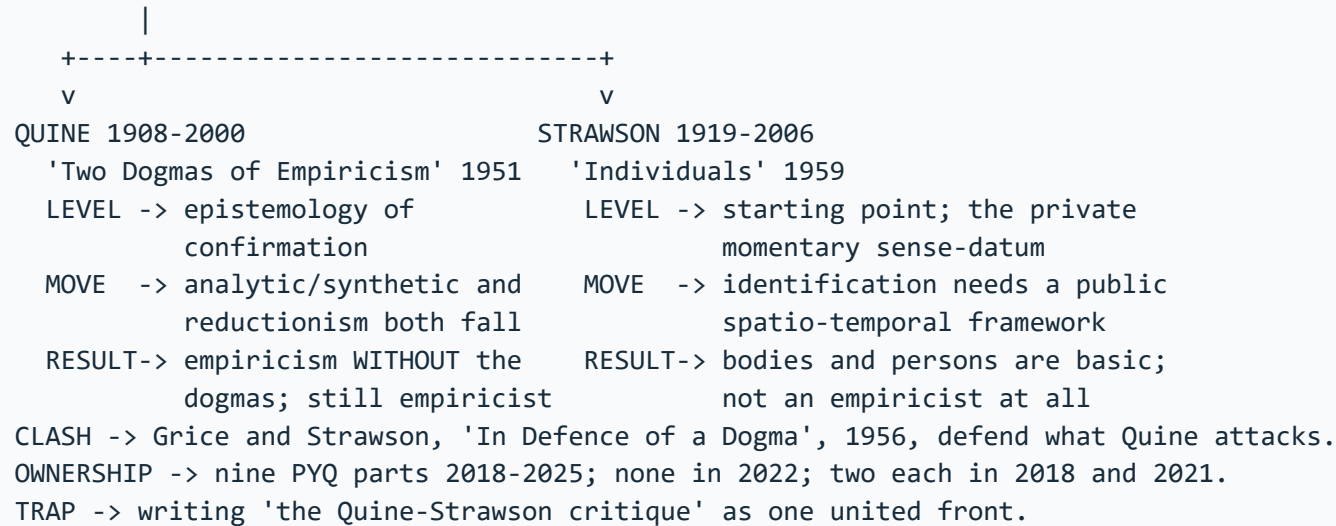


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/10: One heading, two projects: what the clause actually asks

START -> the clause reads: Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons.

TARGET -> classical and logical empiricism, attacked at two different levels.



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/10: Dogma one: the circle of synonymy

CLAIM UNDER TEST -> there is a principled line between analytic and synthetic truth.

ANALYTIC = true by virtue of MEANING

|

v

MEANING -> requires SYNONYMY

|

+--> DEFINITION -> only RECORDS an antecedent synonymy -> CIRCULAR

|

+--> INTERCHANGEABILITY salva veritate

|

needs NECESSITY, a cognate of analyticity -> CIRCULAR

|

extensional counter-case: creature with a heart / with a kidney

|

+--> SEMANTIC RULES (Carnap) -> defined via 'analytic-in-L' -> CIRCULAR

OUTCOME -> no principled, non-circular criterion of analyticity.

EXACT CONCLUSION -> a difference of DEGREE (centrality), not of KIND.

OBJECTION -> Grice and Strawson 1956: a usable distinction needs no definition.

REPLY -> usability is not theoretical legitimacy; compare witch / non-witch.

PROVENANCE -> Philosophical Review, January 1951; revised 1953.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/10: Dogma two and the web of belief

DOGMA 2 -> reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.

REFUTATION -> statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.

(o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY

\ \ | / /

[physics, chemistry, biology] <- revised fairly easily

[mathematics] <- revised rarely

[LOGIC] <- revised last, never immune

CLASH AT THE EDGE -> revise somewhere -> the place of revision is CHOSEN.

option A -> adjust a peripheral belief option B -> plead hallucination

option C -> revise a deep interior law

DOCTRINE 1 -> any statement can be held true come what may.

DOCTRINE 2 -> no statement is immune to revision, not even a law of logic.

CONSEQUENCES -> no analytic/synthetic line; no a priori/a posteriori line;

theory-choice by simplicity, conservatism, generality, fecundity;

the verification principle loses its application.

LIMIT -> minimum mutilation, Philosophy of Logic 1970, blocks 'anything goes'.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/10: The Duhem-Quine machinery and its two authors

TESTABLE CLAIM -> (H & A) implies O, where A is background theory and conditions.

|

OBSERVATION -> NOT-O

|

MODUS TOLLENS -> NOT (H & A) only: H is false OR some element of A is false.

|

LOGIC IS SILENT -> the conjunct to surrender is not dictated by the evidence.

|

RESULT -> refutation is never conclusive against a single statement;
 individual verifiability has no application; dogma 2 falls structurally.

+-----+			
Axis	DUHEM 1906	QUINE 1951	
+-----+			
Scope	theoretical physics only	the whole of science	
Logic & maths	exempt	included; none immune	
Corollary	no experimentum crucis	underdetermination	
+-----+			

CASE 1 -> Uranus: revise the auxiliary -> NEPTUNE, Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.

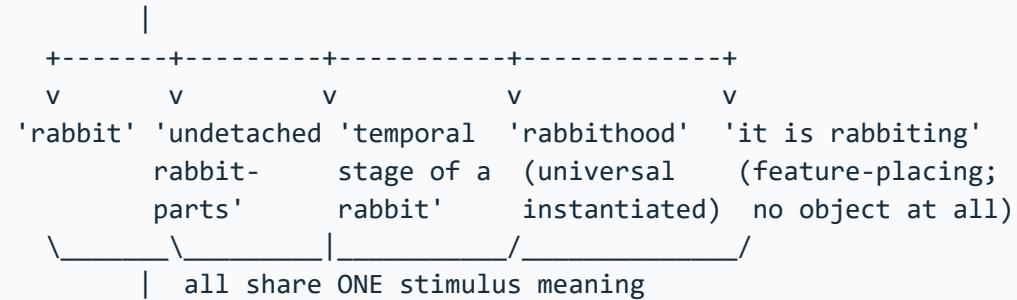
CASE 2 -> Mercury: 'VULCAN' fails -> revise the deep law -> relativity, 1915.

REPLIES -> Popper: falsification is a methodological decision, not pure logic.
 Lakatos: hard core plus revisable protective belt.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/10: Radical translation, gavagai and the three results

SET-UP -> radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter; evidence is
stimulation plus assent or dissent only. Word and Object 1960, ch. 2.

A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.



ASK 'same gavagai?' -> presupposes the identity predicate, articles, plurals,
quantifiers: the APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION in dispute.

|

RESULT 1 -> INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: no fact about what the terms refer to.

RESULT 2 -> INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: rival analytical hypotheses agree on all
observation sentences yet differ elsewhere; nothing decides.

RESULT 3 -> ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY: reference only relative to a background manual.

PREMISES -> behaviourism about evidence; verificationism about facts; naturalism.

OBJECTIONS -> Chomsky: only underdetermination. Davidson: harmless, scale-like.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/10: Quine's positive system and the reform of empiricism

QUESTION 1 -> what is there?

CRITERION -> 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What There Is 1948.

METHOD -> regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.

CONSEQUENCE -> commitment is relative to the regimentation -> ontological relativity.

|

QUESTION 2 -> how do we know?

ANSWER -> naturalized epistemology; philosophy continuous with science,

'a chapter of psychology', 1968/69; sensory input to theoretical output.

IMAGE -> Neurath's boat: rebuilt plank by plank at sea, never in dry dock.

|

QUESTION 3 -> what happens to the a priori?

CHARGE -> no non-circular analyticity + universal revisability + no first

philosophy => holding a belief a priori is a metaphysical article of faith.

|

QUESTION 4 -> is empiricism abandoned?

ANSWER -> no: empiricism WITHOUT the dogmas; experience still governs belief,

holistically rather than sentence by sentence.

BRIDGE -> later Wittgenstein converges (museum myth rejected, holism, anti-private)

but parts on method: Quine REFORMS by regimentation, Wittgenstein DESCRIBES.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/10: Strawson's basic particulars and the identification framework

METHOD -> DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.

contrast -> REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.

provenance -> Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.

|

DEFINITION -> a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.

|

ARGUMENT FROM RE-IDENTIFICATION

1 objective thought requires re-identifying a particular as the same again

2 re-identification requires ONE unified spatio-temporal system

3 material bodies constitute it: three-dimensional, enduring, publicly located

4 sounds, events, private experiences are identified only BY reference to bodies

5 therefore MATERIAL BODIES are basic; PERSONS are the second basic particular

STATUS -> conceptual dependence, not causal or metaphysical priority.

|

TEST -> the purely AUDITORY no-space world

can 'the same sound returning' be distinguished from a duplicate? Only by a
MASTER-SOUND whose pitch fixes position -> a space-analogue is reintroduced.

VERDICT -> the experiment supports the thesis rather than defeating it.

OBJECTION -> Evans: the construction may smuggle in spatial notions.

2020 LINK -> spatio-temporal thinking is a precondition of OBJECTIVE thinking.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/10: Persons: the predicate matrix and the double demolition

THESIS -> the concept of a PERSON is logically PRIMITIVE; not mind plus body assembled.

M-PREDICATES	P-PREDICATES
also true of mere material bodies	states of consciousness and action; only persons
'weighs 70 kg'	others by behavioural criteria; self without observation or criteria -> ASYMMETRY

ARGUMENT

- ```

1 I self-ascribe P-predicates ('I am in pain')
2 a self-ascribable predicate must be understood as ascribable to others
3 other-ascription requires identifying others as single M-and-P subjects
4 therefore the person concept is presupposed by self-ascription itself

```



## BLOCKS CARTESIAN DUALISM

two independent substances cannot  
be the ONE subject; P-predicates  
become unlearnable and other minds  
unknowable

## BLOCKS THE NO-OWNERSHIP THEORY

'the experiences had by this body'  
covertly restores the ownership it  
denies; Schlick and Lichtenberg's  
'it thinks' is self-refuting

GUARD -> not logical behaviourism: behaviour is criterial evidence, not meaning.

OBJECTIONS -> co-instantiation rather than primitiveness; Ayer on no-ownership.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/10: Reference, presupposition and Strawson's own anti-empiricism

TEST SENTENCE -> 'The present King of France is bald' (there is no such king).

|            |                             |                           |  |
|------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|--|
| +-----+    |                             |                           |  |
| Issue      | RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905   | STRAWSON, On Referring    |  |
|            |                             | 1950                      |  |
| +-----+    |                             |                           |  |
| Who refers | the sentence, by quantifier | people, in a USE          |  |
| Existence  | ASSERTED in the analysis    | PRESUPPOSED, not asserted |  |
| Empty term | the statement is FALSE      | a TRUTH-VALUE GAP         |  |
| Meaning    | truth-conditions of a type  | rules for correct use     |  |
| +-----+    |                             |                           |  |

THREE LEVELS -> sentence (meaning) / use (truth-value) / utterance (voicing).

|

STRAWSON AS CRITIC OF EMPIRICISM -> five distinct lines

- 1 sense-data cannot be basic: private, momentary, non-spatial [Individuals I]
- 2 bundle and no-ownership selves collapse -> person is primitive [Individuals 3]
- 3 reference abstracted from use is a mistake [On Referring]
- 4 the global demand to justify induction is senseless [Logical Theory 1952]
- 5 objectivity needs a framework not drawn from experience [Bounds of Sense 1966]

FORM -> take an undisputed fact, ask its conditions, show the empiricist materials fail.

HONEST LIMIT -> descriptive metaphysics maps our scheme, not mind-independent reality.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/10: Confrontation, convergence and the reusable answer spine

|                     |                            |                            |
|---------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| +-----+-----+-----+ |                            |                            |
| Axis                | QUINE                      | STRAWSON                   |
| +-----+-----+-----+ |                            |                            |
| Method              | naturalism                 | descriptive metaphysics    |
| Scheme              | revisable come what may    | core is indispensable      |
| Meaning             | behavioural, indeterminate | fixed by public criteria   |
| Ontology            | read off best science      | the framework we must use  |
| Given               | the whole web of belief    | the public spatio-temporal |
|                     |                            | world                      |

CONVERGENCES -> anti-Cartesian about a private inner object; the public and structured replaces the atomic and private; the museum myth of determinate private meanings is rejected by both.

DO NOT OVERSTATE -> they differ on status, meaning and method; 'they basically agree' is the standing trap on comparative stems.

STANDING PIVOT -> is the conceptual scheme REVISABLE or PRESUPPOSED?

GRADED VERDICT -> the periphery is Quineanly revisable; the framework role looks Strawsonianly indispensable; the truth is layered.

ANSWER SPINE -> 1 decode the directive and name the owner-thinker  
2 thesis in one line  
3 mechanism with the exact term  
4 objection and reply, objector named  
5 graded verdict with a provenance-clean date

TIERS -> 10 marks: steps 1-3 plus a verdict; 15: full spine plus one objection;  
20: full spine, two objections and a convergence close.